

IAS PRELIMS 2020

STATE BY STATE



MEGHALAYA

DEMOGRAPHICAL

GEOGRAPHICAL

ENVIRONMENTAL

CULTURAL

MODULE - 12

1

HIGHS AND LOWS

**MEGHALAYA**

1

Provisions to administer tribal areas under schedule VI.

2

Mawsynram in East Khasi hills receives the highest rainfall on earth.

3

Unlike many Indian states, Meghalaya has historically followed a matrilineal system.

4

Mawlynnong Village, also referred as 'God's own garden' is the cleanest village in India.

5

Nohkalikai Falls near Cherrapunji is the tallest plunge waterfall in India.

6

Krem Liat Prah in Jaintia Hills is the longest natural cave in India.

7

Nongkhnum River island is the biggest river island in Meghalaya and the second biggest river island in Asia, after Majuli Island in Assam.

STATE BY STATE ... MEGHALAYA

2

BOUNDARIES



- **INTERNATIONAL BOUNDARY**
- **STATE BOUNDARY**

BANGLADESH

1

ASSAM

1

NAGALAND

MANIPUR

TRIPURA

MIZORAM

MYANMAR
(BURMA)

BIHAR

SIKKIM

BHUTAN

ARUNACHAL PRADESH

JHARKHAND

WEST BENGAL

- Shares border with only Assam.
- Shares international border with only Bangladesh.



- Meghalaya is geographically termed as the Shillong Plateau or the Meghalaya Plateau.
- Upland area formed by detached block of deccan plateau.
- Plateau consists of mainly rocks of pre-cambrian age.
- Under Seismic Zone – V.



- Landscape of Meghalaya is mostly rolling plateau with south-facing slopes being extremely steep.
- Meghalaya was previously part of Assam, but on 21 January 1972, the districts of Khasi, Garo and Jaintia hills became the new state of Meghalaya.



ASSAM

GARO HILLS

KHASI HILLS

JAINTIA HILLS

MEGHALAYA

MANIPUR

MIZORAM

SH

- Central part of the plateau comprising the Khasi Hills has the highest elevations, followed by the eastern section comprising the Jaintia Hills region.
- Garo Hills region in the western section of the plateau is nearly plain.

RELIEF FEATURES - PEAKS

**HILL**

- Garo
- Khasi
- Jaintia

HIGHEST PEAK

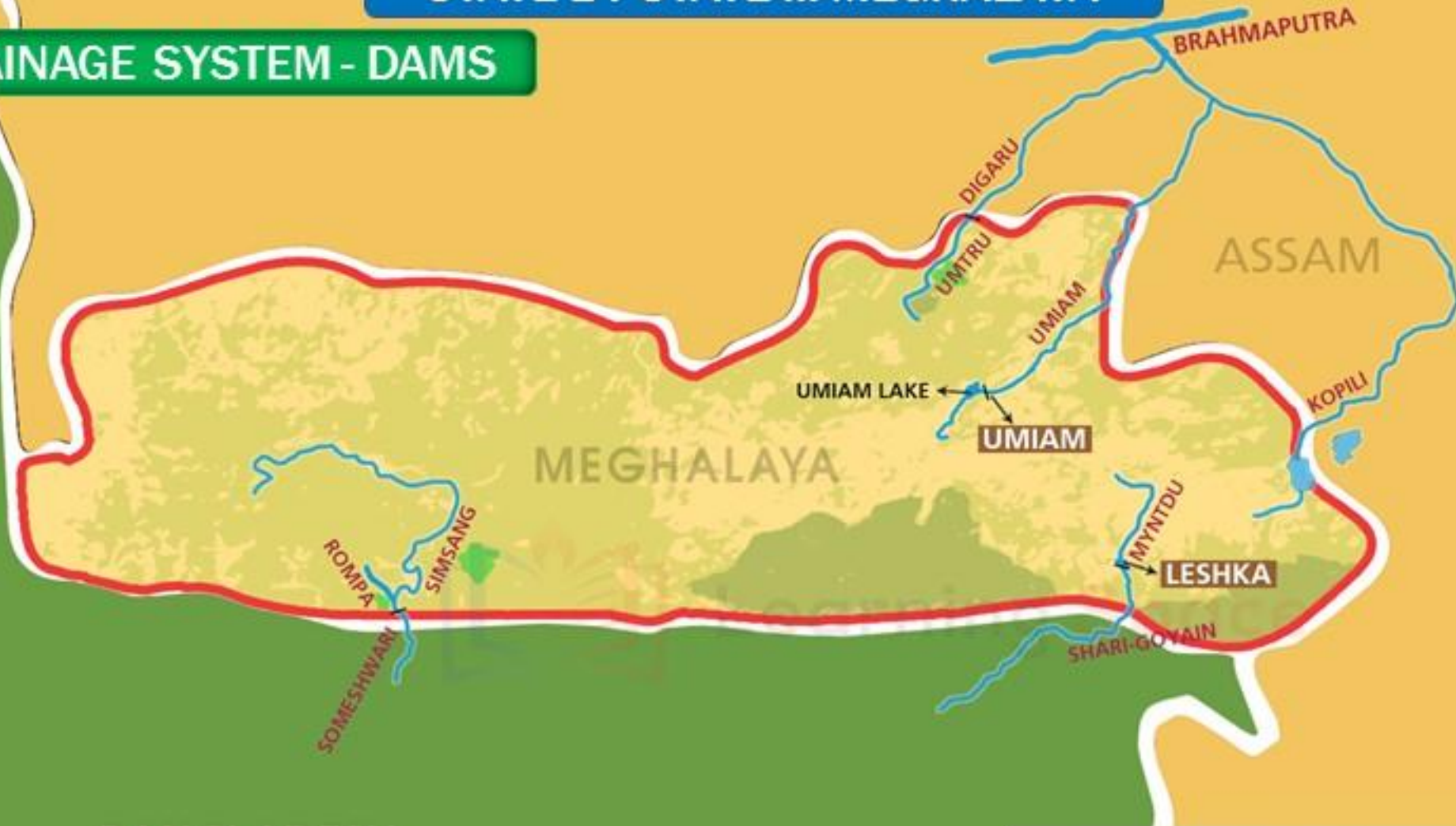
- Nokrek Peak
- Lum Shyllong or Shillong peak
- Maryngksih peak

Shillong Peak: Highest point in Meghalaya. Prominent IAF station in the Khasi Hills overlooking the city of Shillong.



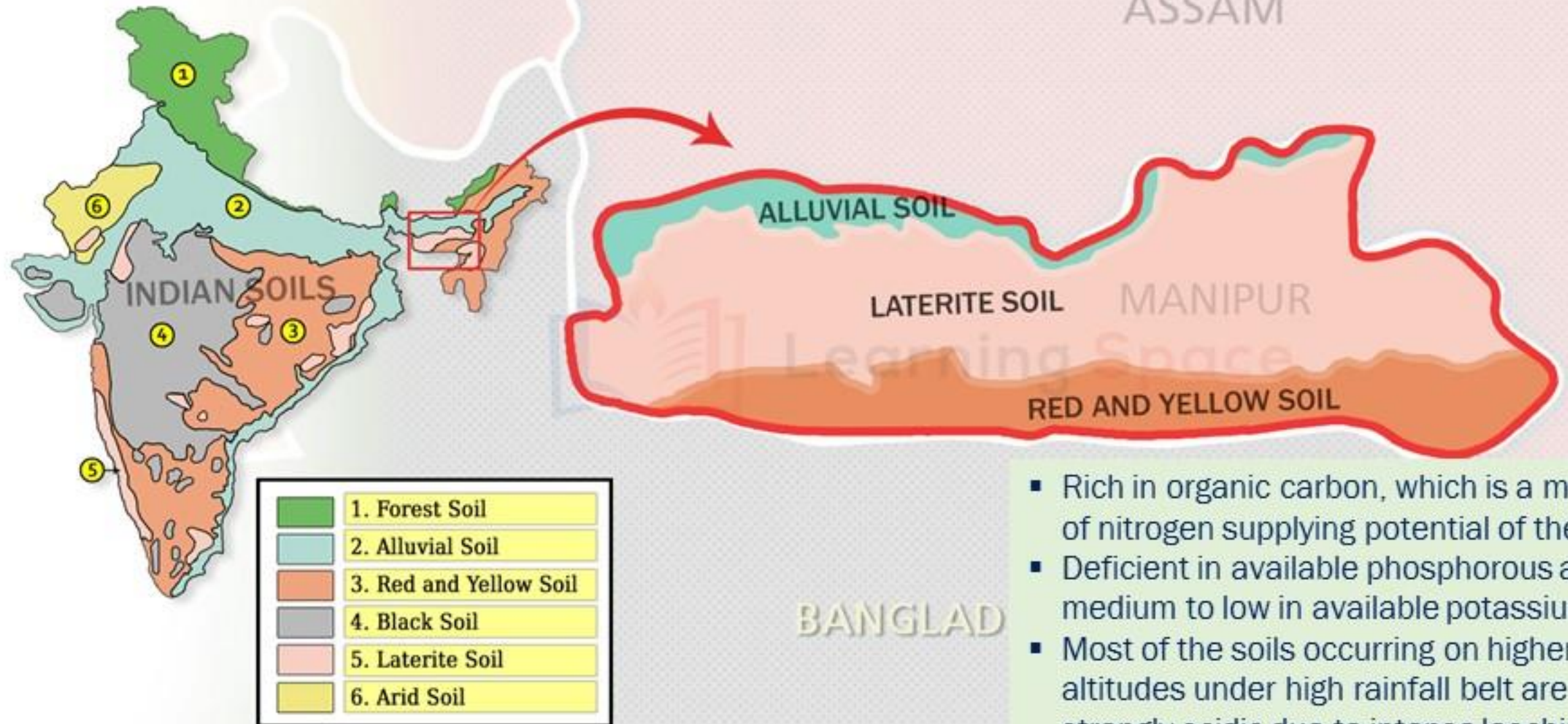
- Someshwari River
 - ✓ known as Simesang River in Meghalaya,
 - ✓ originate from the Nokrek peak, and
 - ✓ major river in the Garo Hills and divides it into two parts.
- Myntdu River
 - ✓ Known as 'Shari' in Bangladesh

Kopili River: originates in the Meghalaya plateau and flows through Central Assam and the hill districts of Assam before its confluence with the Brahmaputra.



■ DAMS

- Umiyam lake is a man-made reservoir formed upon construction of Umiyam Dam.
- Silting and pollution is reducing the life-span of Umiyam dam.



- Rich in organic carbon, which is a measure of nitrogen supplying potential of the soil.
- Deficient in available phosphorous and medium to low in available potassium.
- Most of the soils occurring on higher altitudes under high rainfall belt are strongly acidic due to intense leaching.

STATE BY STATE ... MEGHALAYA

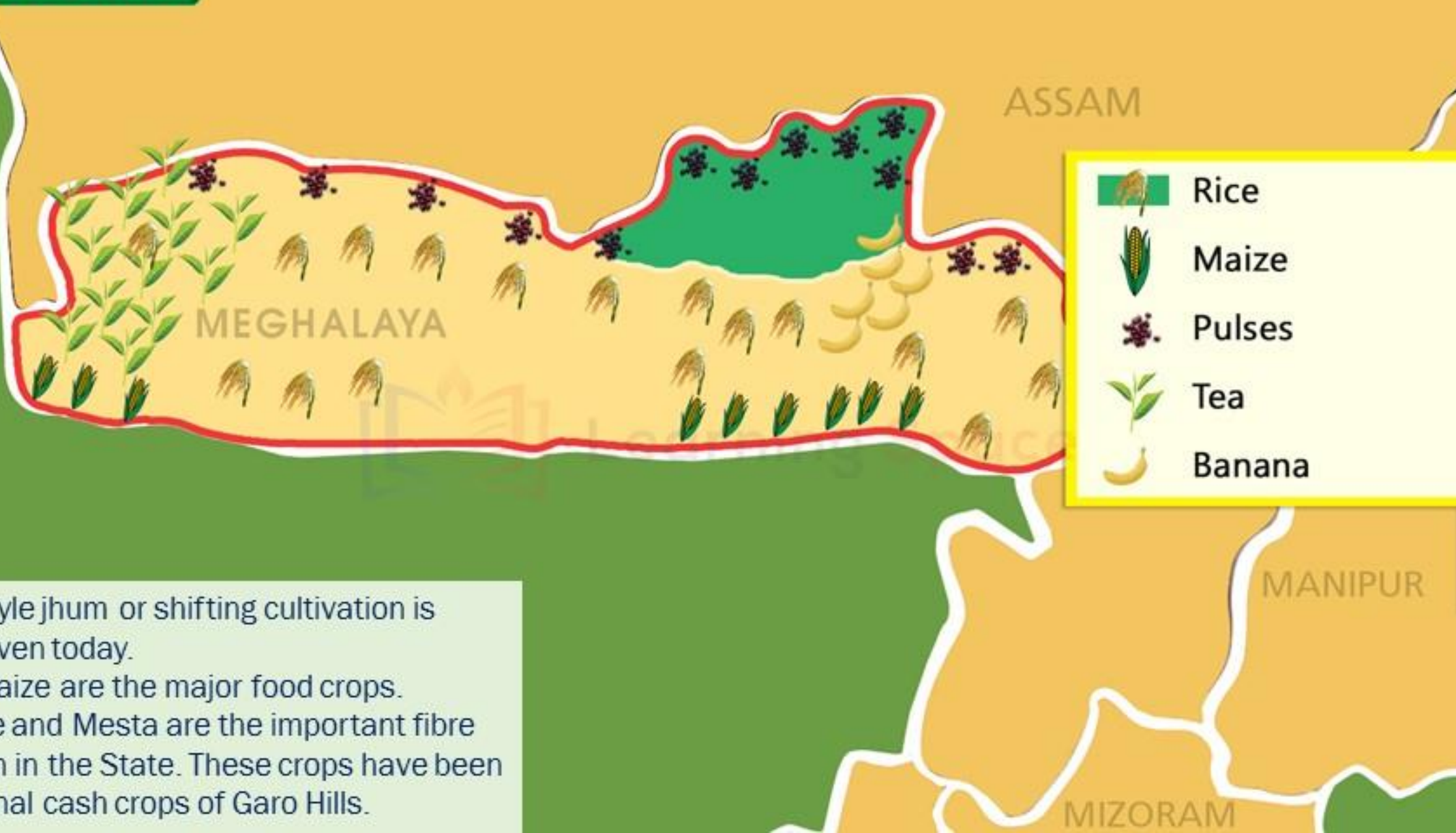
NORTHEAST MONSOON



SOUTHWEST MONSOON

ANDAMAN & NICOBAR ISLANDS (INDIA)

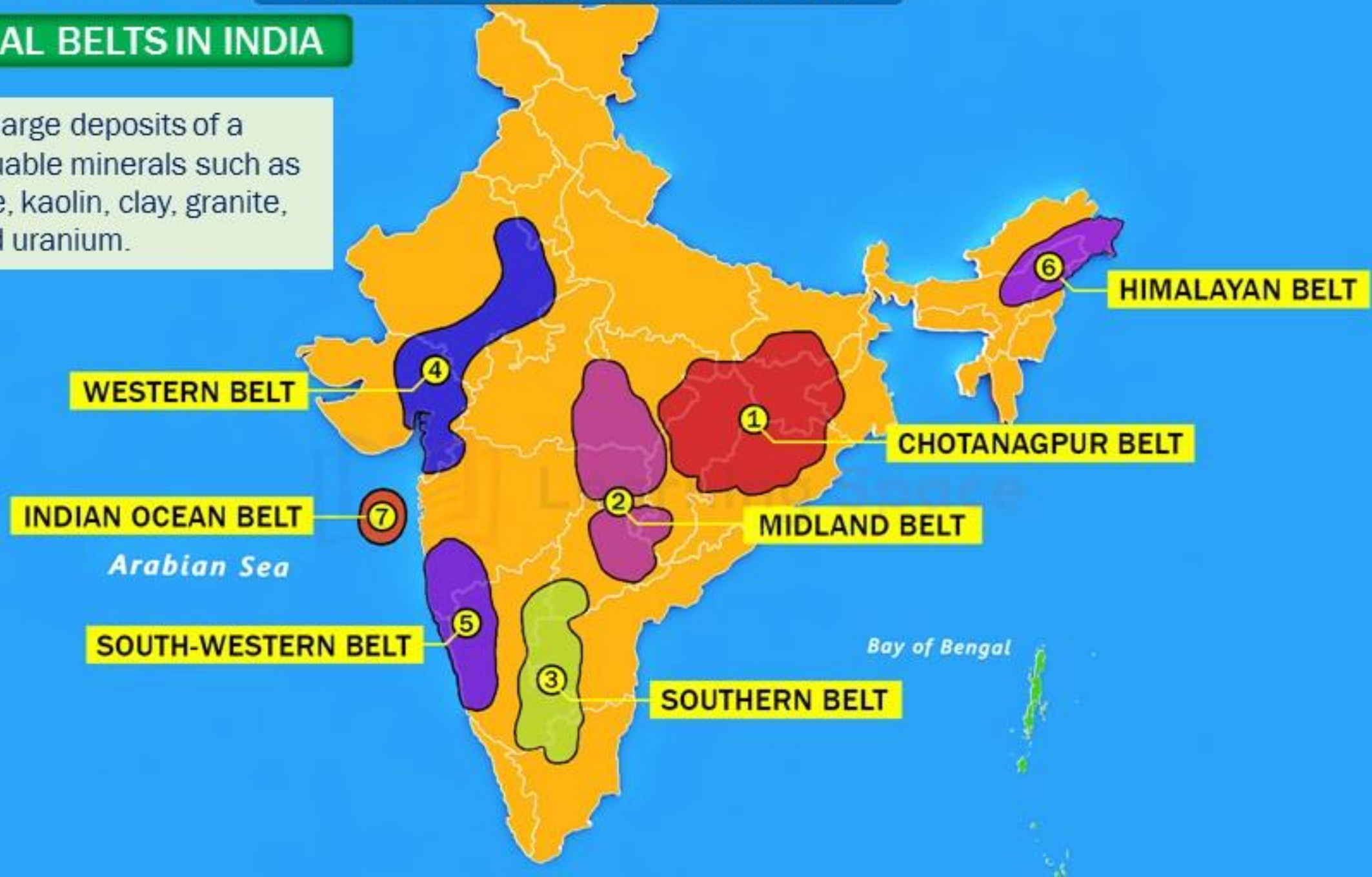
- Monsoon type of climate but with wide variation.
- Amongst the highest rainfall areas in the world (mostly Orographic Rainfall due to south-west monsoon).
- Khasi and Jaintia hills have a very soothing climate because of high altitude.
- Garo hills are too hot and humid in summers.



- Neolithic style jhum or shifting cultivation is practised even today.
- Rice and Maize are the major food crops.
- Cotton, Jute and Mesta are the important fibre crops grown in the State. These crops have been the traditional cash crops of Garo Hills.

8 MINERAL BELTS IN INDIA

- Endowed with large deposits of a number of valuable minerals such as coal, limestone, kaolin, clay, granite, glass-sand and uranium.





■ HYDROELECTRIC POWER PLANT

Myntdu Leshka Hydro Electric Power project:

- ✓ A Run Off River (ROR) Scheme, located at the Jaintia Hills District.

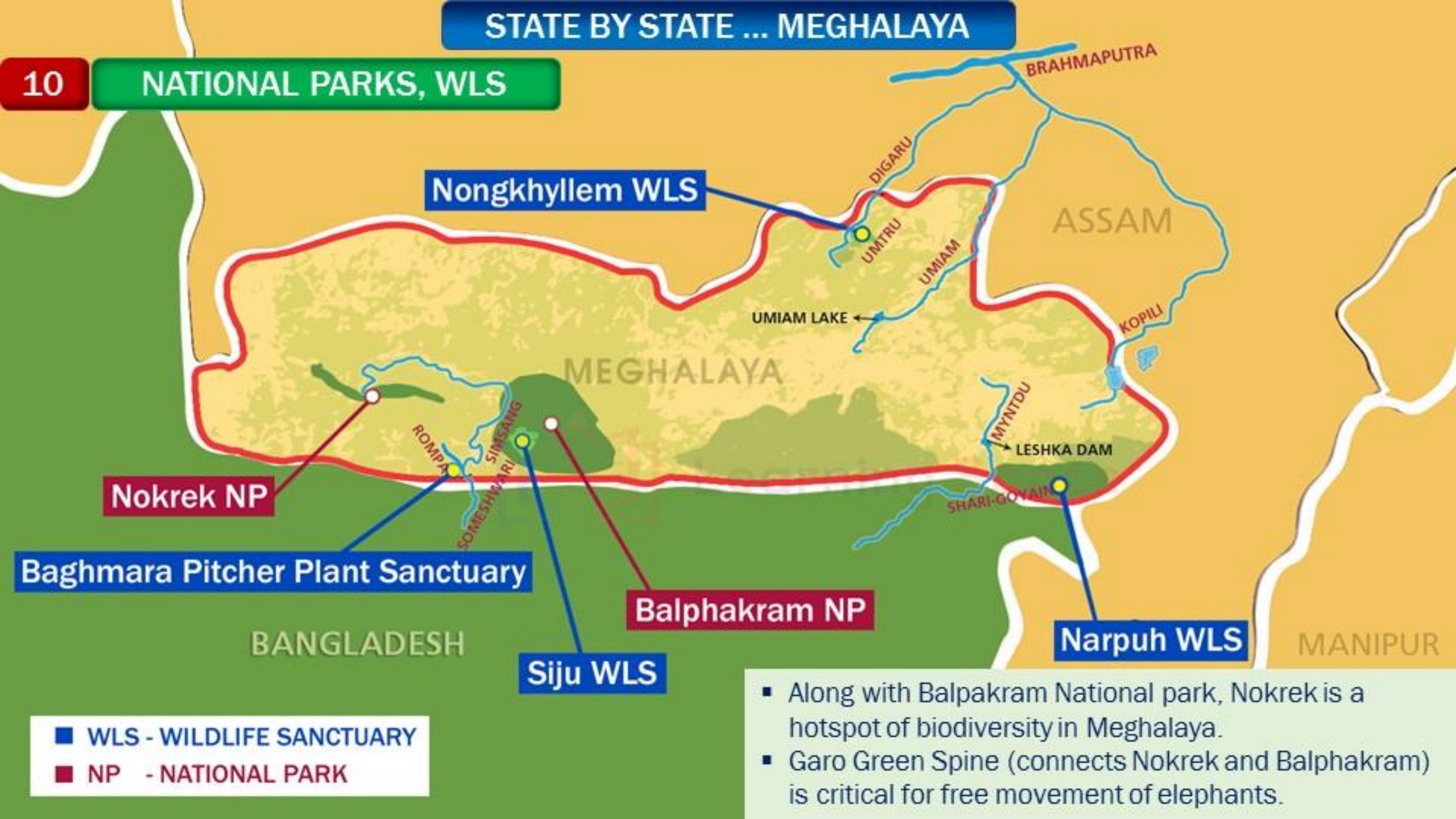


- Proposed bridge over the Brahmaputra River between Assam and Meghalaya
- Planned to be completed by 2026-27 and span more than 19 kms, would be India's longest bridge over water.

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NATIONAL PARKS, WLS



Nongkhylllem WLS

Nokrek NP

Baghmara Pitcher Plant Sanctuary

Balphakram NP

Siju WLS

Narpuh WLS

■ WLS - WILDLIFE SANCTUARY

■ NP - NATIONAL PARK

- Along with Balpakram National park, Nokrek is a hotspot of biodiversity in Meghalaya.
- Garo Green Spine (connects Nokrek and Balphakram) is critical for free movement of elephants.



■ BR - BIOSPHERE RESERVE

- Located in the northeast of India on the Tura Range, which forms part of the Meghalaya Plateau.
- Nokrek NP is the core area of Nokrek Biosphere Reserve.
- UNESCO's Man and the Biosphere (MAB) programme added it to the World Network of Biosphere Reserves.

STATE BY STATE ... MEGHALAYA

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ELEPHANT RESERVES



WANGALA FESTIVAL



- Post-harvest festival that marks the end of the agricultural year celebrated by the Garo tribe.
- Most popular festival of the Garo hills, and is held in November.

BEHDIENTKHLAM FESTIVAL



- Most popular festival of the Jaintia tribe.
- 'Behdienkhlam' literally means 'to drive away evils (Beh dien) and plague (khlam)'.
- Festival is observed by non-Christian 'Pnars' who believe in the traditional faith of "Niamtre".
- One of the most colourful religious festivals.

NONGKREM DANCE



- Dance of the Khasi tribe
- Held every year at smit, near Shillong.
- Associated mostly with goat sacrifice.

GARO



- Originally belong to the Bodo family of the Tibeto-Burman race.
- Both men and women wear bangles, jewellery and head-dresses during festivals.
- Follow matrilineal lineage.
- Set up an institution of Bachelor's Dormitories wherein young people are kept together till they get married.

KHASI



- Khasis at Jaintia hills are known as Jaintias.
- Those living in the northern plains and foot of the hills are called Bhois.
- Ones in the southern hills are called Wars.
- Matrilineal style of lineage.
- One cannot marry within the same clan.

JAINTIA



- Sub-tribe of Khasis
- Jaintia along with Khasis, Wars, Pnars are known as Hynniewtrep.
- Jaintia tribes along with Khasis include the following groups :
 - ✓ Bhoi in the northern Meghalaya
 - ✓ Khynriam in the central Meghalaya
 - ✓ Pnar of the Jaintia hills
 - ✓ War in the southern Meghalaya
- Matrilineal style of lineage.

MONOPTERUS RONGSAW



- A blood-red, snake-like creature with an elongated body and sightless black spots for eyes, was spotted burrowing into the moist soil of a rainforest in Meghalaya.

HOOLOCK GIBBON



- Listed on Schedule 1 of the Wildlife Protection Act 1972.
- IUCN Status:
 - ✓ Western Hoolock Gibbon – Endangered
 - ✓ Eastern Hoolock Gibbon – Vulnerable
- Both species' populations have been declining due to habitat destruction of various forms and hunting for meat.

CLOUDED LEOPARD



- *State animal of Meghalaya.*
- *Added to India's Recovery Programme For Critically Endangered Species.*
- *Included on CITES Appendix I.*
- *IUCN Status: Vulnerable*

SHILLONG BUBBLE NEST FROG



- *Endemic to Greater Shillong in Meghalaya.*
- *Associated with Tropical Moist Forest*
- *IUCN Status: Critically Endangered*

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IN RECENT NEWS

EXERCISE HAND-IN-HAND 2019



- 8th India-China joint training exercise
- Conducted at Umroi, Meghalaya.
- Objective: To practice joint planning and conduct of counter terrorist operations in semi-urban terrain.

MAITREE 2019



- Indo-Thailand Joint Military Exercise
- Annual training event is held alternatively in Thailand and India.
- 2019 edition held in Umroi, Meghalaya.

HYNNIEWTREP NATIONAL LIBERATION COUNCIL (HNLC)



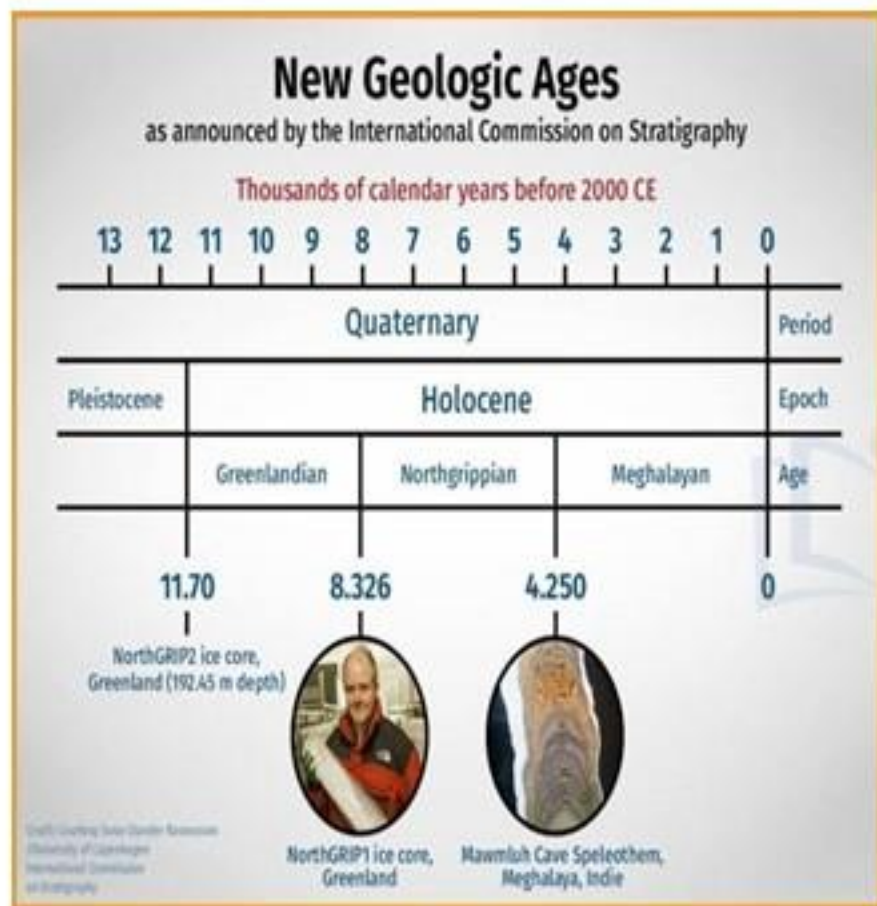
- Meghalaya based insurgent group.
- Banned by the central government for its increased activities of violence and other subversive acts.
- Banned in exercise of the powers conferred by Section 3 (1) of the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act, 1967.

RAT-HOLE MINING



- Involves digging of very small tunnels, usually only 3-4 feet high, which workers (often children) enter and extract coal.
- Despite a ban, rat-hole mining remains the prevalent procedure for coal mining in Meghalaya.
- Caused the water in the Kopili river (flows through Meghalaya and Assam) to turn acidic.
- It is preferred over open cast mining where the coal seam is thin.

MEGHALAYAN AGE



- *Began 4200 years ago.*
- *Comes under Holocene Epoch*
- *Stalagmite from Mawmluh Cave in Meghalaya which preserved transition of the ages helps in inventing this age.*
- *Geologists have also introduced two other age classifications:*
 - ✓ *Greenlandian Age (11,700 - 8,326 years ago) - began when the last ice age ended and the world began to warm up.*
 - ✓ *Northgrippian Age (8,326 – 4,200 years ago) – began after an abrupt global cooling started following the Greenlandian Age.*

LIVING ROOT BRIDGES



- *Aerial bridges built by weaving and manipulating the roots of the Indian rubber tree.*
- *Uses traditional tribal knowledge to train the roots.*
- *Research on the structural aspects to integrate them in modern urban architecture and build eco-friendly cities.*

ENTRY LAW FOR VISITORS IN MEGHALAYA



- Meghalaya Cabinet has approved amendments to the Meghalaya Residents Safety and Security Act (MRSSA) 2016.
- The ordinance makes registration on entry mandatory for visitors who intend to spend more than 24 hours in the state.
- This will require non-resident visitors to register themselves on the lines of the Inner Line Permit (ILP) system of Arunachal Pradesh, Nagaland, and Mizoram.
- In the original Act the focus was on registration and documentation of tenants but the amendments will extend similar rules to all non-state residents visiting or living in the state.

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